PRINTABLE CHRISTMAS PARTY GAME

Christmas Trivia Game

200 Questions

10 themed rounds with answer keys, a host script, team answer sheets and a score sheet

THE 10 ROUNDS

1. Christmas Traditions
2. Christmas Around the World
3. Festive Food and Drink
4. Christmas History
5. The Nativity Story
6. Winter and Nature
7. Christmas Words and Names
8. True or False
9. Kids' Round
10. Christmas Numbers

16 PAGES · US LETTER, PRINTS ON A4 · INSTANT DOWNLOAD

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How to Play

SET UP

- Teams of 2 to 6 players. The score sheet fits up to 10 teams.
- Print one Team Answer Sheet (page 15) per team for each round.
- Print one Team Score Sheet (page 16) for the host.
- Keep the answer keys (pages 13 and 14) with the host.

PLAY AND SCORE

- Read each question twice. Teams write one answer.
- One point each: 20 a round, 200 in all.
- Joker: once per game a team may double one round, if it says so before the round.
- Teams swap sheets and mark them as you read the answers.

HOST SCRIPT: READ IT OUT

TO START	“Welcome to Christmas Trivia! Ten rounds, twenty questions each. Write your team name on your sheet.”
EACH ROUND	“Round [number]: [name]. Jokers, speak now. I'll read every question twice. Ready?”
AFTER A ROUND	“Pencils down! Pass your sheet to the team on your left and mark it as I read the answers.”
THE FINALE	“The scores are in. In third place... in second place... and our champions are...”

TIPS FOR A SMOOTH GAME

- Each round takes about 15 minutes with marking. Short on time? Play any 4 rounds in about an hour.
- Round 9 is an easy Kids' Round: use it as a warm-up or as a round for younger players.
- A tie at the end? Three closest-number tie-breakers are on the score sheet (page 16).
- Keep a timer handy: about 30 seconds per question keeps every round moving.

ROUND 1 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Christmas Traditions

Customs, decorations and old habits from Christmases past

1. From which date do most Advent calendars start, with one door opened each day?
2. Under which hanging plant are people traditionally supposed to kiss at Christmas?
3. Which saint is said to have staged the first live nativity scene, in Italy?
4. What evergreen ring of branches is often hung on the front door at Christmas?
5. Which husband of Queen Victoria made the Christmas tree fashionable in Britain?
6. In Ireland, December 26 is the feast day of which saint?
7. Which British table novelty holds a paper crown, a joke and a small gift?
8. Which church feast on January 6 remembers the visit of the wise men?
9. On which saint's day, December 6, do European children leave out shoes for treats?
10. Which Swedish festival on December 13 features a girl wearing a crown of candles?
11. What large log was traditionally burned in the hearth over the Christmas season?
12. Tinsel was first made in the 1600s from thin strips of which precious metal?
13. What do children hang up on Christmas Eve to be filled with small gifts?
14. Sir Henry Cole of London commissioned the first commercial version of what, in 1843?
15. Which red Christmas plant is named after Joel Poinsett, a US diplomat?
16. What old custom involves going door to door, singing and drinking to good health?
17. In Ireland, a candle in the window on Christmas Eve welcomes which holy couple?
18. What is the name for the last evening of the Christmas season, before Epiphany?
19. Edward Johnson showed the first electric tree lights. He worked for which inventor?
20. Which prickly-leaved evergreen with red berries is a classic Christmas decoration?

ROUND 2 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Christmas Around the World

How other countries celebrate the season

1. In which country is a bucket of fried chicken a popular Christmas Eve meal?
2. In Italy, what is the name of the kind old witch who brings gifts on January 6?
3. In Dutch tradition, Sinterklaas arrives by steamboat from which country?
4. Crowds gather on Bondi Beach on Christmas Day. In which country is Bondi Beach?
5. Which Mexican nine-night custom re-enacts Mary and Joseph's search for lodging?
6. In Iceland, how many mischievous Yule Lads visit children before Christmas?
7. In Iceland's Christmas Eve 'book flood' tradition, what do people give each other?
8. What is Father Christmas called in France?
9. Which German city's Christkindlesmarkt is one of the world's most famous?
10. In Catalonia, children tap a smiling log, the Tió de Nadal, until it 'gives' them what?
11. In Ukraine, Christmas trees are often decorated with ornaments shaped like what?
12. In Norway, what household item is hidden on Christmas Eve, away from witches?
13. What is the star-shaped lantern that symbolizes Christmas in the Philippines?
14. In which country's capital, Caracas, do people roller-skate to early Christmas Mass?
15. In Spain, who traditionally bring children their gifts on January 6?
16. In Poland, an extra place is set at the Christmas Eve table for whom?
17. In Poland, Christmas Eve dinner traditionally waits until what appears in the sky?
18. Each year, Oslo, Norway, gives a giant Christmas tree to which city as a thank-you?
19. In Greece, which saint traditionally brings children gifts on January 1?
20. What is the Russian name of Grandfather Frost, the New Year gift-bringer?

ROUND 3 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Festive Food and Drink

Puddings, cookies and holiday feasts

1. On 'Stir-up Sunday', British families traditionally prepare which dessert?
2. Finding a coin hidden in your Christmas pudding is said to bring you what?
3. Which spirit is warmed and set alight over a Christmas pudding before serving?
4. Mince pies were once filled with what, besides dried fruit and spices?
5. Which German Christmas bread has dried fruit, often marzipan, and a sugar coat?
6. What tall, domed sweet bread from Milan is eaten at Christmas in Italy?
7. What French Christmas cake is shaped and decorated like a log?
8. Which small German spiced cookies have a name that means 'pepper nuts'?
9. Which Puerto Rican coconut Christmas drink is often compared to eggnog?
10. Which tart red berry sauce is traditionally served with roast turkey?
11. The Italian-American Christmas Eve 'Feast of the Seven' what?
12. What hot spiced wine is sold at German Christmas markets?
13. Which bird was the usual English Christmas roast before turkey took over?
14. What steamed corn-dough parcels do many Mexican families make at Christmas?
15. Marzipan is made mainly from sugar and which ground nut?
16. Turrón, a nougat of honey and almonds, is a Christmas sweet from which country?
17. The old Christmas drink wassail is mainly hot spiced what: cider, milk or tea?
18. Spiced speculaas cookies are a holiday treat from which country?
19. Swedish St. Lucia buns get their golden color from which spice?
20. Which nuts are sold hot from street carts in many European cities in winter?

ROUND 4 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Christmas History

Dates, firsts and famous Christmas moments

1. In which year did Christmas become a US federal holiday: 1790, 1870 or 1950?
2. Which English author wrote the story 'A Christmas Carol'?
3. In which year was 'A Christmas Carol' first published: 1743, 1843 or 1943?
4. In 'A Christmas Carol', what is the name of Scrooge's dead business partner?
5. What was the World War I ceasefire when enemy soldiers met at Christmas called?
6. Which religious group in England's Parliament banned Christmas in 1647?
7. Which American colony banned celebrating Christmas from 1659 to 1681?
8. Who is usually credited with the poem 'A Visit from St. Nicholas'?
9. In which year was 'A Visit from St. Nicholas' first published: 1823, 1873 or 1923?
10. Which US president lit the first National Christmas Tree in 1923?
11. Which cartoonist drew Santa for Harper's Weekly from the 1860s on?
12. The oldest record of a December 25 Christmas, in Rome, is from which century?
13. Which Roman winter festival honoring the god Saturn was held in December?
14. Which crewed space mission orbited the Moon on Christmas Eve 1968?
15. Which king of the Franks was crowned emperor in Rome on Christmas Day, 800?
16. In which year was William the Conqueror crowned king on Christmas Day?
17. Which German-born printer is called the father of the American Christmas card?
18. In 1955, a misprinted phone number led which US command to 'track' Santa?
19. Which general led his army across the Delaware River on Christmas night 1776?
20. Christmas seals, charity stamps for holiday mail, began in 1904 in which country?

ROUND 5 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

The Nativity Story

Facts from Luke 1-2 and Matthew 1-2 (King James Version)

1. In which town was Jesus born?
2. Which Roman emperor decreed 'that all the world should be taxed'?
3. Who was governor of Syria when that taxing was made: Cyrenius, Herod or Pilate?
4. From which town in Galilee did Joseph and Mary travel?
5. Joseph was 'of the house and lineage' of which king?
6. Where did Mary lay the baby, 'because there was no room for them in the inn'?
7. In the King James Version, what was the baby wrapped in?
8. Who were 'abiding in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night'?
9. Which angel was sent to Nazareth to tell Mary she would have a son?
10. The angel told the shepherds, 'I bring you good tidings of great' what?
11. According to Matthew, from which direction did the wise men come to Jerusalem?
12. What did the wise men see and follow?
13. Name the three gifts the wise men brought.
14. Which king was 'troubled' when the wise men asked about the King of the Jews?
15. To which country did Joseph take Mary and the young child to escape Herod?
16. How were the wise men warned not to go back to Herod?
17. What name did the angel tell Joseph to give the child?
18. Which name in Matthew 1:23 means 'God with us'?
19. Which cousin of Mary became the mother of John the Baptist?
20. Complete the heavenly host's praise from Luke 2:14: 'Glory to God in the ...'

ROUND 6 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Winter and Nature

Animals, plants and the science of the season

1. Which reindeer still have antlers on Christmas Day: adult males or females?
2. The red 'petals' of a poinsettia are really what?
3. Which evergreen climbing plant is traditionally paired with holly?
4. A snowflake starts as ice forming around a tiny speck of what?
5. Mistletoe grows on the branches of other trees. What kind of plant does that make it?
6. Which red-breasted bird appears on so many British Christmas cards?
7. Fir, spruce and pine trees have cones and needles. What group of trees are they?
8. In winter, reindeer footpads shrink so the hard hoof rim can do what?
9. What is special about each hair of a reindeer's winter coat that keeps it warm?
10. What color is a polar bear's skin under its fur?
11. What is the name of the cold region around the North Pole?
12. Which large white owl lives on the Arctic tundra?
13. What is the common name for the aurora borealis?
14. Are holly berries safe for people to eat?
15. Which ancient Celtic priests held mistletoe sacred?
16. What do we call a mass of snow that suddenly slides down a mountainside?
17. Reindeer can see a kind of light that humans cannot. Which kind?
18. What do pine cones open up to release?
19. What is the name for the winter weeks in the far north when the sun does not rise?
20. What do squirrels bury in autumn to dig up and eat in winter?

ROUND 7 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Christmas Words and Names

Where our Christmas words come from

1. The 'X' in 'Xmas' comes from which Greek letter, the first letter of 'Christ' in Greek?
2. What does the word 'Advent' mean?
3. 'Yule' began as a midwinter festival of which ancient peoples?
4. The name 'Santa Claus' comes from 'Sinterklaas'. Which language is that?
5. 'Kris Kringle' comes from the German 'Christkindl'. What does it mean?
6. The word 'Epiphany' comes from Greek. What does it mean?
7. 'Boxing Day' is said to come from boxes of what, given to workers?
8. In Mexico, the poinsettia is 'flor de Nochebuena'. What is 'Nochebuena'?
9. Which Dickens character's name now means a mean, grumpy person?
10. Complete Scrooge's famous grumble: 'Bah! ...'
11. The word 'carol' first described what: a dance, a cake or a candle?
12. What does the old greeting 'wassail' mean?
13. What is another name for the wise men, from a Persian word for priests?
14. An orange with a candle, a red ribbon and sweets on sticks is called a what?
15. What does the German word 'Tannenbaum' mean?
16. 'Mele Kalikimaka' means Merry Christmas in which language?
17. 'Buon Natale' means Merry Christmas in which language?
18. 'Frohe Weihnachten' means Merry Christmas in which language?
19. The 'mas' at the end of 'Christmas' comes from which church service?
20. What does the Greek word 'Christos' mean?

True or False

Teams write T or F. Half are true, half are false

1. The Bible says there were exactly three wise men.
2. In Matthew, the wise men find the young child in a house.
3. Christmas was once banned in parts of England and in colonial Massachusetts.
4. Holly is a type of pine tree.
5. St. Nicholas was a bishop in what is now Turkey.
6. Charles Dickens wrote 'A Christmas Carol' in about six weeks.
7. Poinsettias are deadly poisonous to people.
8. Christmas trees were first lit with electric lights in the 1700s.
9. Christmas Day is a national public holiday in Japan.
10. Myrrh is a resin that comes from a tree.
11. The North Pole sits on solid land.
12. Many Orthodox Christians in Russia celebrate Christmas on January 7.
13. Snow can fall even when the air at the ground is above freezing.
14. Advent always begins on December 1.
15. A farm-grown Christmas tree usually takes 7 years or more to reach selling size.
16. Boxing Day is named after a boxing match held every December 26.
17. Christmas falls in winter in Argentina.
18. Christmas Island is a real island in the Indian Ocean.
19. Reindeer cannot swim.
20. The name Bethlehem means 'house of bread'.

ROUND 9 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Kids' Round

Easy questions for younger players (or a warm-up for everyone)

1. What color is Santa's suit?
2. Where does Santa live?
3. Which animals pull Santa's sleigh?
4. What vegetable is often used for a snowman's nose?
5. Which cookie is shaped like a little person?
6. What do we hang on the Christmas tree to decorate it?
7. How many days are in December?
8. On which date is Christmas Day?
9. What red-and-white striped candy is shaped like a hook?
10. What snack do children leave out for Santa on Christmas Eve?
11. What cold white flakes fall from the sky in winter?
12. What are Santa's little helpers called?
13. What does Santa say when he laughs?
14. What shape is often put on the very top of a Christmas tree?
15. What is a glass ball with a tiny scene inside that you shake to make it snow?
16. What do you ride to slide down a snowy hill?
17. What warm chocolate drink is often topped with marshmallows?
18. Which animals were the shepherds looking after?
19. Which season comes after autumn?
20. What do children write to Santa to say what they wish for?

ROUND 10 OF 10 · 20 QUESTIONS · 1 POINT EACH

Christmas Numbers

Counting, dates and holiday math (pencils allowed)

1. A team scores 17 points in each of 10 rounds. What is its total score?
2. If Christmas Day falls on a Monday, which day of the week is New Year's Day?
3. How many days after Christmas Day is New Year's Day?
4. How many candles ring a traditional Advent wreath?
5. In which year did the World War I Christmas Truce take place?
6. Not counting Marley, how many spirits visit Scrooge in 'A Christmas Carol'?
7. How many chapters, called 'staves', does 'A Christmas Carol' have?
8. When 'A Christmas Carol' begins, Marley has been dead for how many years?
9. How many doors does a standard Advent calendar have?
10. How many hours are there in the twelve days of Christmas?
11. How many legs do eight reindeer have altogether?
12. A dozen mince pies plus half a dozen more: how many pies is that?
13. By number, which month of the year is December?
14. If the winter solstice is on December 21, how many days later is Christmas Day?
15. How many letters are in the word CHRISTMAS?
16. Roughly how far is Bethlehem from Jerusalem: 6, 60 or 600 miles?
17. Counting both days, how many days are there from December 1 to December 25?
18. How many days after Christmas Day is Epiphany, on January 6?
19. How many minutes are there in Christmas Day?
20. 24 party guests split into teams of 4. How many teams is that?

FOR THE HOST ONLY

Answer Key: Rounds 1 to 5

Round 1 · Christmas Traditions

1. December 1
2. Mistletoe
3. St. Francis of Assisi
4. A wreath
5. Prince Albert
6. St. Stephen
7. Christmas cracker
8. Epiphany
9. St. Nicholas
10. St. Lucia's Day
11. The Yule log
12. Silver
13. Stockings
14. Christmas card
15. Poinsettia
16. Wassailing
17. Mary and Joseph
18. Twelfth Night
19. Thomas Edison
20. Holly

Round 2 · Christmas Around the World

1. Japan
2. La Befana
3. Spain
4. Australia
5. Las Posadas
6. 13
7. Books
8. Père Noël
9. Nuremberg
10. Sweets and gifts
11. Spider webs
12. Brooms
13. Parol
14. Venezuela
15. The Three Kings
16. An unexpected guest
17. The first star
18. London
19. St. Basil
20. Ded Moroz

Round 3 · Festive Food and Drink

1. Christmas pudding
2. Good luck
3. Brandy
4. Minced meat
5. Stollen
6. Panettone
7. Bûche de Noël
8. Pfeffernüsse
9. Coquito
10. Cranberry sauce
11. Fishes
12. Glühwein
13. Goose
14. Tamales
15. Almonds
16. Spain
17. Cider (or ale)
18. The Netherlands
19. Saffron
20. Chestnuts

Round 4 · Christmas History

1. 1870
2. Charles Dickens
3. 1843
4. Jacob Marley
5. The Christmas Truce
6. The Puritans
7. Massachusetts
8. Clement C. Moore
9. 1823
10. Calvin Coolidge
11. Thomas Nast
12. The 4th century
13. Saturnalia
14. Apollo 8
15. Charlemagne
16. 1066
17. Louis Prang
18. CONAD (now NORAD)
19. George Washington
20. Denmark

Round 5 · The Nativity Story

1. Bethlehem
2. Caesar Augustus
3. Cyrenius
4. Nazareth
5. David
6. In a manger
7. Swaddling clothes
8. The shepherds
9. Gabriel
10. Joy
11. From the east
12. A star
13. Gold, frankincense, myrrh
14. Herod
15. Egypt
16. In a dream
17. Jesus
18. Emmanuel
19. Elisabeth
20. Highest

FOR THE HOST ONLY

Answer Key: Rounds 6 to 10

Round 6 · Winter and Nature

1. Females
2. Leaves (bracts)
3. Ivy
4. Dust (or pollen)
5. A parasite
6. The robin
7. Conifers
8. Grip ice and snow
9. It is hollow
10. Black
11. The Arctic
12. The snowy owl
13. The northern lights
14. No, they are toxic
15. The Druids
16. An avalanche
17. Ultraviolet
18. Seeds
19. Polar night
20. Nuts and acorns

Round 7 · Christmas Words and Names

1. Chi
2. Coming (arrival)
3. Germanic and Norse
4. Dutch
5. Christ Child
6. Appearance
7. Gifts
8. Christmas Eve
9. Scrooge
10. Humbug
11. A dance
12. Be well (good health)
13. The Magi
14. Christingle
15. Fir tree
16. Hawaiian
17. Italian
18. German
19. Mass
20. The anointed one

Round 8 · True or False

1. False
2. True
3. True
4. False
5. True
6. True
7. False
8. False
9. False
10. True
11. False
12. True
13. True
14. False
15. True
16. False
17. False
18. True
19. False
20. True

Round 9 · Kids' Round

1. Red
2. The North Pole
3. Reindeer
4. A carrot
5. Gingerbread man
6. Ornaments
7. 31
8. December 25
9. Candy cane
10. Cookies and milk
11. Snow
12. Elves
13. Ho ho ho!
14. A star
15. A snow globe
16. A sled
17. Hot chocolate
18. Sheep
19. Winter
20. A letter

Round 10 · Christmas Numbers

1. 170
2. Monday
3. 7
4. 4
5. 1914
6. 3
7. 5
8. 7
9. 24
10. 288
11. 32
12. 18
13. 12th
14. 4
15. 9
16. About 6 miles
17. 25
18. 12
19. 1,440
20. 6

Tie-breaker answers (questions on page 16): 1. 1947 2. 1223 3. 359

PRINT AS MANY AS YOU NEED

Team Answer Sheet

Print one per team for each round. Write neatly: another team marks it.

TEAM NAME _____ ROUND ☐

1		11	
2		12	
3		13	
4		14	
5		15	
6		16	
7		17	
8		18	
9		19	
10		20	

Round score ☐ / 20 Joker played this round? ☐

FOR THE HOST

Team Score Sheet

Write each team's score after every round. Circle the round a team played its Joker and count it twice.

TEAM	R1	R2	R3	R4	R5	R6	R7	R8	R9	R10	TOTAL

TIE-BREAKERS: CLOSEST NUMBER WINS

Still tied at the end? The host reads one of these. Each team writes a number; the closest wins. Answers are on page 14.

1. In which year did Oslo first give London its Trafalgar Square Christmas tree?
2. In which year did St. Francis of Assisi stage his live nativity scene at Greccio?
3. Counting both days, how many days are there from January 1 to December 25 in a non-leap year?

You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations